

Bringing your spending into alignment with your season and your values means identifying and accepting what makes sense for *you* in this timing, where you've come from, and where you want to be going. Because it's not just about this current season, it's also about the future. It's important to value and put resources toward the seasons to come both near and distant. Whether that means planning and preparing for a fun vacation or getting your finances to a good place in order to move, retire well, or pay for your child's college. All of it will require prioritization and embracing the limitations of your season while also allowing yourself to be the dynamic, flexible, innovative renegade you are!

But we also understand the flip side. Your season may not make you feel like a renegade. Instead it might make you feel just plain 'ol tired. Sometimes previous seasons, experiences, and mindsets around money can keep you from seeing what's possible in your current season.

Whether unfortunate events happened, or you chose a challenging path, life can be really crummy. We acknowledge that even though we have control over some things, we don't have control over all things! And regardless of whether the cause was our choice, other people's choices, or natural occurrences, there can be a corresponding emotional impact.

This can create obstacles for moving forward, future thinking and planning, or identifying hope. If you find yourself living in a perpetual state of stress, anxiety, and exhaustion, it can lead to difficulties in making wise financial decisions, or even identifying what you want your life to look like.

This book is not about exiting the stress response cycle or effectively treating anxiety, but it is worth noting these factors play into tough seasons and may help you understand why life doesn't and can't always look the way influencers attempt to portray it. Having knowledge of and naming our current obstacles and difficulties is what allows us to understand, value, and live as best as possible *within* the circumstances.

Your "radical middle," the version of life that allows you to find and spend on the things you value while also recognizing and rejecting the things that don't, will come with parameters. Our seasons rarely allow us to do and buy all the things we want, but it's here that we can allow our creativity to flourish.

In research conducted by the *Harvard Business Review*,¹ it was found that in a variety of settings, teams of people functioned best when given reasonable constraints for a project. Those with parameters like a budget, a